Paloma Piot

Postdoctoral Researcher in Natural Language Processing

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Summary

Postdoctoral researcher at the IRLab, Universidade da Coruña, working on computational methods for hate speech detection, multilingual NLP, and model explainability. PhD (cum laude, 2026) as a Marie Skłodowska-Curie doctoral candidate in the HYBRIDS project.

Education

PhD **Universidade da Coruña**, Natural Language Processing / Computer Science — A Coruña, Spain
- Thesis: Explainable and Efficient Language Models for Hate Speech Detection — Oct 2023 – Sept 2026
- Cum laude, defended 21 September 2026
- Marie Skłodowska-Curie doctoral candidate within the HYBRIDS project

MSc **Universidade da Coruña**, Computer Science — A Coruña, Spain
- Thesis on early risk detection of mental disorders in social media — 2018 – 2020

BSc **Universidade da Coruña**, Computer Science — A Coruña, Spain, 2014 – 2018

Experience

IRLab - Universidade da Coruña, Postdoctoral Researcher — A Coruña, Spain
- Research on perspectivist approaches to hate speech detection with LLMs — Oct 2026 – present, 1 month

IRLab - Universidade da Coruña, Marie Skłodowska-Curie Doctoral Researcher — A Coruña, Spain
- PhD thesis on hate speech detection within the HYBRIDS project — Oct 2023 – Oct 2026, 3 years 1 month

Publications

Personalisation or Prejudice? Addressing Geographic Bias in Hate Speech Detection using Debias Tuning in Large Language Models — 2026
Paloma Piot, Patricia Martín-Rodilla, Javier Parapar
ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/42726 (ICWSM 2026)

Decoding Hate: Exploring Language Models' Reactions to Hate Speech — 2025
Paloma Piot, Javier Parapar
aclanthology.org/2025.naacl-long.45 (NAACL 2025)

Towards Efficient and Explainable Hate Speech Detection via Model Distillation — 2025
Paloma Piot, Javier Parapar
link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-031-88711-6_24 (ECIR 2025)

WATCHED: A Web AI Agent Tool for Combating Hate Speech by Expanding Data — 2025
Paloma Piot, Diego Sánchez, Javier Parapar
www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2352711025003978 (SoftwareX 32, 2025)

MetaHate: A Dataset for Unifying Efforts on Hate Speech Detection 2024
Paloma Piot, Patricia Martín-Rodilla, Javier Parapar
ojs.aaai.org/index.php/ICWSM/article/view/31445 (ICWSM 2024)

Awards

Best Open Source Project Award Oct 2021
Awarded by Universidade da Coruña for the best open-source university project in 2021.

Skills

Natural Language Processing: Hate Speech Detection, Dataset Construction, Multilingual NLP, Benchmarking

Machine Learning: LLMs, Model Distillation, Explainability, Debiasing

Languages

Spanish
Native speaker

Galician
Native speaker

English
Fluent (C1)

Projects

HYBRIDS Oct 2023 – Oct 2026
European research project focused on hybrid intelligence to monitor, promote and analyse transformations in good democracy practices.

- Human-in-the-loop hate speech detection
- Multilingual and low-resource language focus
- Ethical and explainable AI for content moderation